

ones by a sizeable margin. For most point and shoots, size and portability are the defining parameters, giving limited options to the manufacturers with their biggest concern being the ease with which they can fit into a tiny bag or pocket and quickly be taken out for a quick click. On the other hand, with SLRs, stability and sheer ruggedness are given far more importance, irrespective of the big dedicated bag you'll need to haul them around in.

Difference between an SLR and a dSLR

Superior modularity is a common feature in most SLR cameras, especially towards the higher-end, comprising typically of three sections: the lens assembly, the camera body and the Image Back. In simple analog cameras, your roll of film (generally a 35 mm film) forms the image back, while in SLRs this roll is replaced with electronic sensors. These sensors are responsible for converting light into electronic information which can be stored and read on a computer. As explained earlier, the larger size with lesser constraints in the design of SLRs, as compared to point and shoots, allows them to make use of physically larger sensors, making a huge difference in image quality – the main reason why people pick an SLR camera over simpler point and shoot alternatives.



Which one to choose

Image sensors

Clearly, image sensors are of extreme importance in SLRs. Next, we'll take a quick look at the technology used there. Today, most digital still cameras use either Charged Coupled Device (CCD) or Complementary Metal Oxide Semi-Conductor (CMOS) chips. Both types accomplish the same task of converting the captured light into electrical signals. CCD technology entered the market earlier than CMOS, yet most small sensor cameras (up to full frame 35 mm) make use of the CMOS chips. On the other hand, the medium or large format cameras with the larger sensor are almost all CCD still. When light strikes the CCD chip, each photo sensor holds it as a